PARTY GAME PACK

Gingerbread House Contest Kit

Score cards, ballots and certificates for kids, teen and adult divisions

15 PAGES

PRINTABLE · INSTANT DOWNLOAD

GM's Digital Creations

START HERE

How to Run Your Contest

Everything prints on US Letter (fits A4). Print the pages you need, cut the cards on the dashed lines and you are ready.

The plan in six steps

1. Pick a date, a build time (60 to 90 minutes works well) and a theme if you want one, then fill in the Host Plan on page 3.
2. Print the Team Sign-Up Sheet and let guests form teams of 1 to 4 people. Each team picks the division that matches its oldest builder.
3. Read the Official Rules out loud before the timer starts, and hand every team a Build Plan page to sketch their house.
4. When time is up, judges walk the table with one Score Card per team and rate five criteria from 1 to 5.
5. Add the judges' points on the Results Tally Sheet. The highest total in each division wins; ties go to the higher Creativity score.
6. Guests vote with People's Choice ballots, then you hand out the certificates while everyone admires the houses.

What is inside

- [ ] Host plan and supply checklist
- [ ] Official rules and divisions
- [ ] Team sign-up sheet
- [ ] Team build plan
- [ ] Judge score cards (2 per page)
- [ ] Judging guide for fair scores
- [ ] Results tally sheet
- [ ] People's Choice ballots (8 per page)
- [ ] 12 award categories
- [ ] Certificates for kids, teens, adults and special awards

Divisions

KIDS

Ages 12 and under

A grown-up may hold walls while the icing sets.

TEENS

Ages 13 to 17

Teens build on their own or in teen-only teams.

ADULTS

Ages 18 and up

Mixed-age teams enter here.

HOST

Host Plan and Supply Checklist

Fill this in a week before the party so the day runs itself.

DETAIL	YOUR PLAN
Contest date	
Start time / build time	
Theme (optional)	
Judges (2 or 3 people)	
Prizes	
Where houses will be displayed	

Supplies

- [ ] Gingerbread house kit or baked walls, one per team
- [ ] Royal icing in piping bags (2 per team)
- [ ] Sturdy base: cake board, cutting board or foil-covered cardboard
- [ ] Candy bowls: gumdrops, peppermints, pretzels, candy canes
- [ ] Cereal, mini marshmallows and shredded coconut for snow
- [ ] Canned goods or cups to hold walls while icing sets
- [ ] Paper towels, wet wipes and table covers
- [ ] Timer or phone alarm, pens for judges
- [ ] Printed score cards, ballots and certificates
- [ ] A small prize for each division winner

Party timeline

TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
30 min before	Set out bases, icing and candy bowls; tape team names to each spot
Start	Welcome, read the rules, hand out build plans
5 min	Teams sketch their plan
Build	60 to 90 minutes of building; call out the halfway point
Judging	Judges score while guests vote People's Choice
Awards	Read winners from the tally sheet and hand out certificates

Official Contest Rules

Read these out loud before the timer starts.

1. Every house must stand on its own base. Bases may not be shared between teams.
2. Everything on the house must be edible except the base and any support cans removed before judging.
3. Teams may bring up to three special candies from home; everything else comes from the shared bowls.
4. Build time is set by the host. When the timer ends, hands off; no more icing or candy.
5. Walls may be propped while the icing sets but must stand alone at judging.
6. Kids may get help holding walls from one grown-up. Decorating is done by the kids.
7. Judges score each house on five criteria from 1 to 5, for a top score of 25 per judge.
8. Judges may not score a team they belong to. If they do, the host drops that card.
9. Ties are broken by the higher Creativity score, then by a coin toss.
10. Be kind. Every builder gets a cheer when the winners are read.

Our house rules

Add your own rules here, such as a theme, a candy limit or a surprise ingredient.

Team Sign-Up Sheet

Write each team's name, builders and division. The table number tells judges where to find them.

#	TEAM NAME	BUILDERS	DIVISION	TABLE
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

PLAN

Team Build Plan

Five minutes to plan before you pipe. Sketch the front of your house and list your candy jobs.

TEAM NAME	DIVISION	TABLE

SKETCH THE FRONT OF YOUR HOUSE

Our theme or story

JOB	WHO DOES IT
Walls and roof	
Icing and snow	
Doors and windows	
Roof decoration	
Yard and path	

Judge Score Cards

One card per team per judge. Circle a score for each line and add the total.

Judge Score Card

TOTAL OUT OF 25

Team _____ Judge _____

Division ☐ Kids ☐ Teens ☐ Adults

Creativity Original idea, theme or story	1	2	3	4	5
Structure Walls and roof stand straight and strong	1	2	3	4	5
Decoration detail Careful candy work, patterns and texture	1	2	3	4	5
Neat icing Clean lines and seams	1	2	3	4	5
Wow factor How it looks from across the room	1	2	3	4	5

Comments _____ **Total** /25

Judge Score Card

TOTAL OUT OF 25

Team _____ Judge _____

Division ☐ Kids ☐ Teens ☐ Adults

Creativity Original idea, theme or story	1	2	3	4	5
Structure Walls and roof stand straight and strong	1	2	3	4	5
Decoration detail Careful candy work, patterns and texture	1	2	3	4	5
Neat icing Clean lines and seams	1	2	3	4	5
Wow factor How it looks from across the room	1	2	3	4	5

Comments _____ **Total** /25

Judging Guide

Share this with judges so a 3 means the same thing at every table.

CRITERION	1 POINT	3 POINTS	5 POINTS
Creativity	Plain kit house	A clear theme or one surprise detail	An idea nobody else had, carried all the way through
Structure	Walls lean or roof slides	Stands straight with small gaps	Square, sturdy, clean corners, nothing propped
Decoration detail	Candy placed at random	Some patterns and texture	Planned patterns, layered textures, tiny details
Neat icing	Smudged and drippy	Mostly tidy seams	Crisp lines, even piping, clean snow
Wow factor	Easy to walk past	Makes people stop	Everyone gathers around it

Tips for judges

- Score each house on its own, then compare across a division only to break ties.
- Use 2 and 4 for houses between the descriptions.
- Kids are judged against kids, teens against teens, adults against adults.
- Judges never score their own family's team.

Tie breakers

1. Higher Creativity score wins.
2. Still tied: higher Wow factor score.
3. Still tied: coin toss by the youngest guest.

A sample scored card: 21 out of 25

CRITERION	SCORE	WHY THE JUDGE GAVE IT
Creativity	5	A ski lodge with a pretzel ski rack and a frozen pond
Structure	4	Straight walls, roof slipped a little on one side
Decoration detail	4	Peppermint path and shingles in rows
Neat icing	3	Snow is neat, seams are smudged
Wow factor	5	Guests crowded around it

Results Tally Sheet

Copy each judge's card total. Add across for the team total (top score 75 with three judges).

TEAM	DIVISION	JUDGE 1	JUDGE 2	JUDGE 3	TOTAL	RANK

VOTE

People's Choice Ballots

Every guest gets one vote. Cut on the dashed lines.

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

People's Choice

My favorite house is team _____

Table number _____

Because _____

Voter name (optional) _____

AWARDS

12 Award Categories

Give the Grand Champion in each division, then add as many special awards as you have builders.

AWARD	GIVEN FOR
Grand Champion	Highest total score in the division
Golden Gumdrop	Best use of colorful candy
Rooftop Royalty	Best roof: shingles, snow or tiles
Sturdiest Build	Still standing straight at the end
Pretzel Architect	Most creative use of pretzels
Winter Wonderland	Best snow scene and yard
Master Piper	Neatest icing work
Window Wizard	Best doors and windows
Story Builder	Best theme or story
Most Delicious	The one everyone wants to eat
Team Spirit	Best teamwork and kindness
People's Choice	Most guest votes

Kids Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Kids Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Golden Gumdrop

proudly presented to

for the most colorful candy work in the Kids Division

Judge

Date

Teen Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Teen Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Rooftop Royalty

proudly presented to

for the best roof in the Teen Division

Judge

Date

ADULTS

Adult Division Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Grand Champion

proudly presented to

for building the top-scoring gingerbread house in the Adult Division

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Master Piper

proudly presented to

for the neatest icing work in the Adult Division

Judge

Date

ANY DIVISION

Special Award Certificates

Write the builder or team name and sign. Cut on the dashed line.

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

People's Choice

proudly presented to

for winning the most guest votes at our gingerbread house contest

Judge

Date

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

Special Award

proudly presented to

for a gingerbread house that made everyone smile

Judge

Date

You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations